

MarEng Grammar

COUNTABLE NOUNS - PLURALS

The plural ending is -s or -es.

Pronunciation:

- (s) after voiceless sounds
- (z) after voiced sounds
- (iz) after sibilants

Examples:

book	books	(s)
ship	ships	(s)
barrel	barrels	(z)
buoy	buoys	(z)
box	boxes	(iz)
piece	pieces	(iz)
match	matches	(iz)

After a consonant y becomes **ie**
a country countries

COUNTABLE NOUNS - IRREGULAR PLURALS

Note the plurals of the following words:

<u>Sing.</u>	<u>Plur.</u>
a man	men
a woman	women
a child	children
a foot	feet
a tooth	teeth
a mouse	mice
a louse	lice
-lf plurals	-lves
a half	halves
a shelf	shelves
a calf	calves
a wolf	wolves

UNCOUNTABLE NOUNS - IRREGULAR PLURALS

NOTE:

The following nouns are usually uncountable in English. They are used **without a** or **an** and with **a singular verb**.

Note that in other languages these words are often countable.

accommodation	Where is the Captain's accommodation ? (American English allows accommodations .)
behaviour	His behaviour was very bad.
chaos	There is chaos on the quay.
damage	There was damage to the hull.
progress	Progress has been slow.
permission	Permission to come on board is granted.
luck	That was bad luck .
traffic	Traffic has increased.
weather	What is the weather like?
work	Work takes up most of his time.

Some of the following uncountable nouns have a plural meaning. Note the use of a singular verb.

advice	That is good advice .
information	There is no information about the accident.
knowledge	His knowledge is impressive.
news	No news is good news.
furniture	The furniture was old.
baggage	My baggage/luggage weighs 30 kg.
luggage	

To refer to **one item** we can use the expression **a piece of**

- That was **a good piece of advice/ news/ information**.
- What **a lovely piece of furniture**!
- How **many pieces** of luggage do you have?